Payment network financials

Reported FY2021-2025, USD millions. Visa closes in September; Mastercard in December. Fiscal periods differ.

Company

All

Fiscal year

2025

Visa

Revenue
$40.0B

Revenue growth
11.34%

Operating margin
59.99%

Mastercard

Revenue
$32.8B

Revenue growth
16.42%

Operating margin
57.63%

Selected fiscal-year results

Company	Fiscal year	Revenue (USDm)	Operating margin	Operating cash flow (USDm)	Cash conversion	Fiscal period
Mastercard	2025	32,791	57.63%	17,648	1.18x	2025-01-01 to 2025-12-31
Visa	2025	40,000	59.99%	23,059	1.15x	2024-10-01 to 2025-09-30

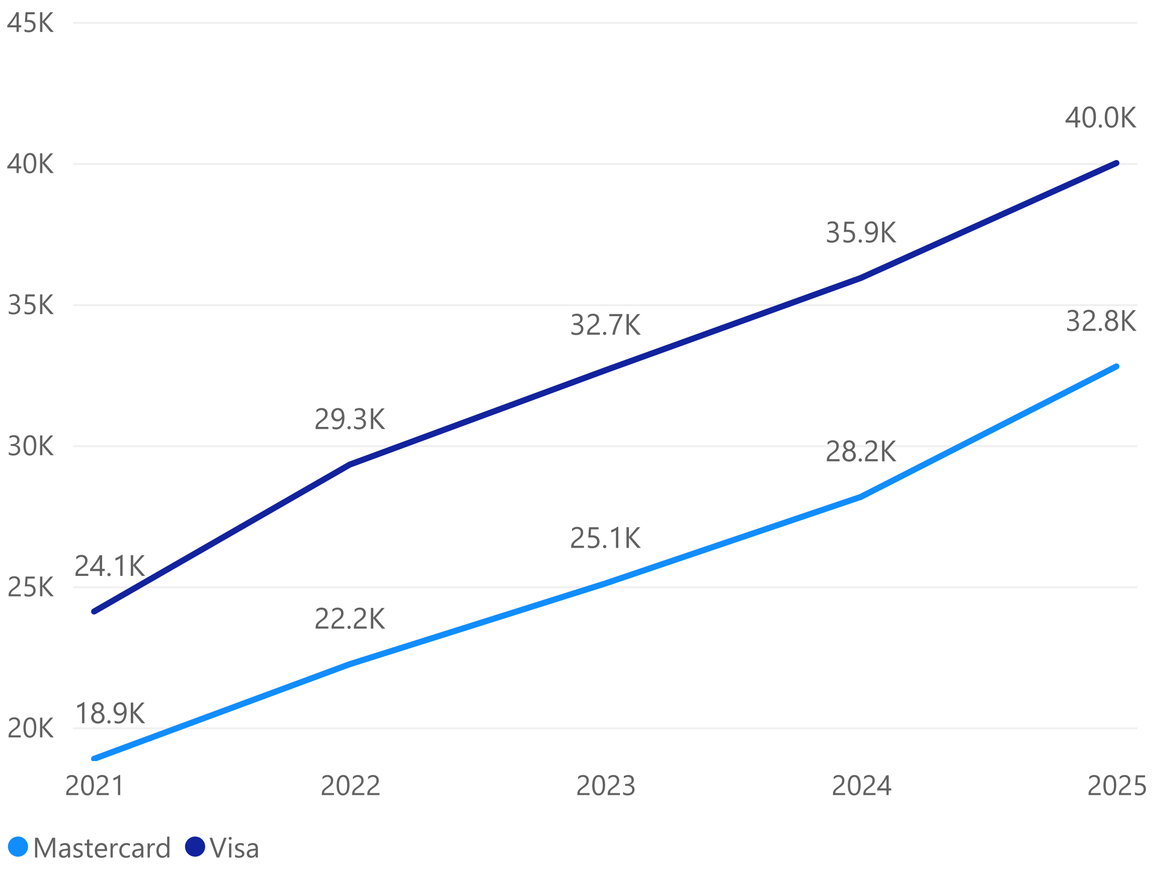
Revenue and operating margin

Five reported fiscal years. Straight lines join annual observations; no calendar or FX normalization.

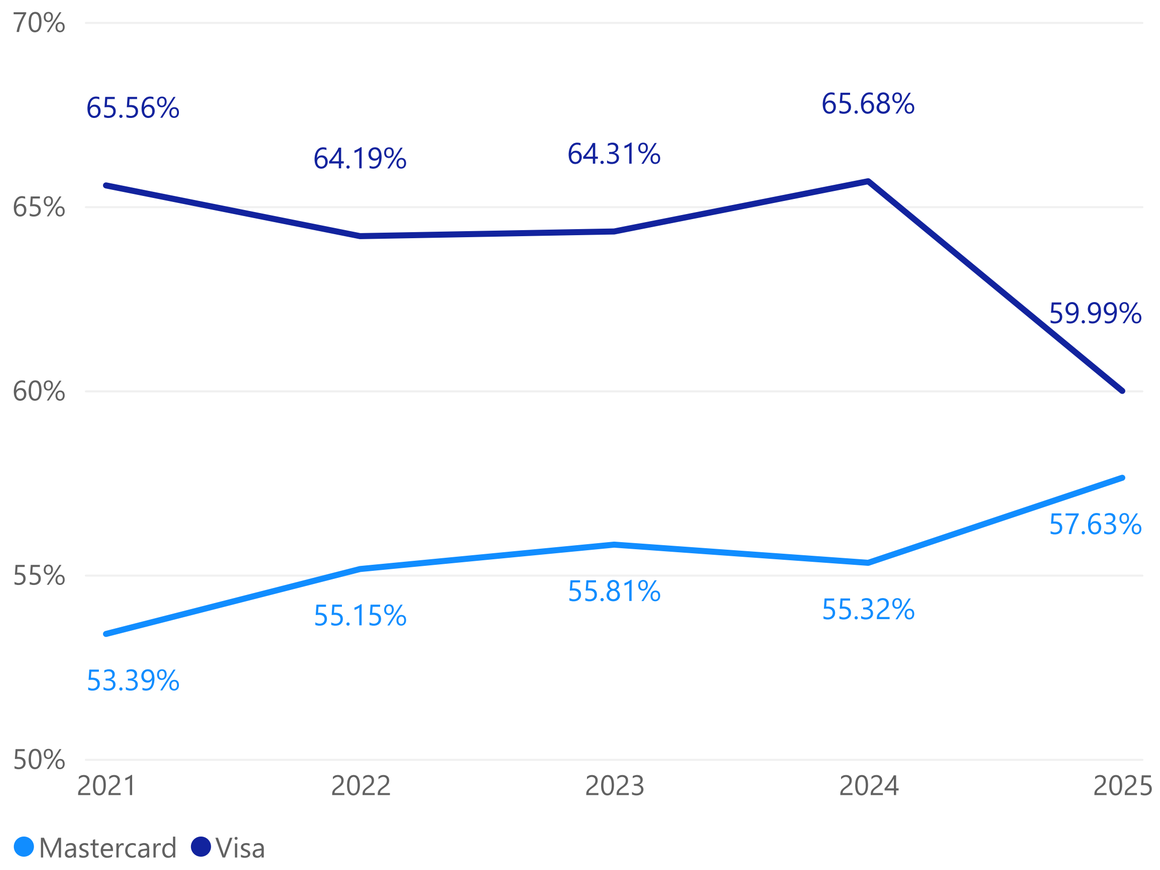
Company

All

Revenue (USDm)



Operating margin



Cash generation and selected debt

USD millions. Debt is the selected carrying amount; cash is cash and cash equivalents, not available liquidity.

Company

All

Fiscal year

2025

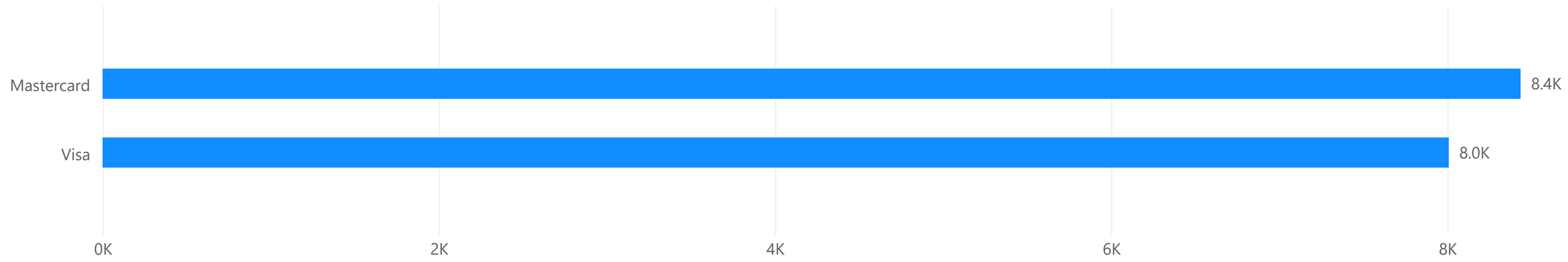
Cash generation

Company	Fiscal year	Operating cash flow (USDm)	Capital payments (USDm)	Free cash flow proxy (USDm)
Mastercard	2025	17,648	1,215	16,433
Visa	2025	23,059	1,482	21,577

Cash and selected debt

Company	Fiscal year	Cash (USDm)	Selected debt (USDm)	Debt less cash (USDm)
Mastercard	2025	10,566	19,000	8,434
Visa	2025	17,164	25,171	8,007

Debt less cash (USDm)



Trace figures to their disclosures

Amounts are shown in USD millions. Original source amounts, pages and URLs remain in the full result tables.

Company

All

Fiscal year

2025

Source register for the selected company and year

Company	Fiscal year	Statement item	Amount (USDm)	Source fiscal year	PDF page	Filing accession	Source link
Mastercard	2025	Capital payments (primary)	489	2025	74	0001141391-26-000013	https://s25.q4cdn....
Mastercard	2025	Capitalized software payments	726	2025	74	0001141391-26-000013	https://s25.q4cdn....
Mastercard	2025	Cash and cash equivalents	10,566	2025	71	0001141391-26-000013	https://s25.q4cdn....
Mastercard	2025	Cash flow total end	13,248	2025	74	0001141391-26-000013	https://s25.q4cdn....
Mastercard	2025	Current debt	749	2025	71	0001141391-26-000013	https://s25.q4cdn....
Mastercard	2025	Income tax	3,610	2025	69	0001141391-26-000013	https://s25.q4cdn....
Mastercard	2025	Net income	14,968	2025	69	0001141391-26-000013	https://s25.q4cdn....
Mastercard	2025	Net revenue	32,791	2025	69	0001141391-26-000013	https://s25.q4cdn....
Mastercard	2025	Noncurrent debt	18,251	2025	71	0001141391-26-000013	https://s25.q4cdn....
Mastercard	2025	Operating cash flow	17,648	2025	74	0001141391-26-000013	https://s25.q4cdn....
Mastercard	2025	Operating expenses	13,894	2025	69	0001141391-26-000013	https://s25.q4cdn....
Mastercard	2025	Operating income	18,897	2025	69	0001141391-26-000013	https://s25.q4cdn....
Mastercard	2025	Pretax income	18,578	2025	69	0001141391-26-000013	https://s25.q4cdn....
Mastercard	2025	Total assets	54,157	2025	71	0001141391-26-000013	https://s25.q4cdn....
Mastercard	2025	Total equity	7,746	2025	71	0001141391-26-000013	https://s25.q4cdn....
Mastercard	2025	Total liabilities	46,411	2025	71	0001141391-26-000013	https://s25.q4cdn....
Visa	2025	Capital payments (primary)	1,482	2025	80	0001403161-25-000089	https://s29.q4cdn....
Visa	2025	Cash and cash equivalents	17,164	2025	74	0001403161-25-000089	https://s29.q4cdn....
Visa	2025	Cash flow total end	24,987	2025	80	0001403161-25-000089	https://s29.q4cdn....
Visa	2025	Current debt	5,569	2025	74	0001403161-25-000089	https://s29.q4cdn....
Visa	2025	Income tax	4,136	2025	75	0001403161-25-000089	https://s29.q4cdn....
Visa	2025	Net income	20,058	2025	75	0001403161-25-000089	https://s29.q4cdn....
Visa	2025	Net revenue	40,000	2025	75	0001403161-25-000089	https://s29.q4cdn....
Visa	2025	Noncurrent debt	19,602	2025	74	0001403161-25-000089	https://s29.q4cdn....
Visa	2025	Operating cash flow	23,059	2025	80	0001403161-25-000089	https://s29.q4cdn....
Visa	2025	Operating expenses	16,006	2025	75	0001403161-25-000089	https://s29.q4cdn....
Visa	2025	Operating income	23,994	2025	75	0001403161-25-000089	https://s29.q4cdn....
Visa	2025	Pretax income	24,194	2025	75	0001403161-25-000089	https://s29.q4cdn....
Visa	2025	Total assets	99,627	2025	74	0001403161-25-000089	https://s29.q4cdn....
Visa	2025	Total equity	37,909	2025	74	0001403161-25-000089	https://s29.q4cdn....
Visa	2025	Total liabilities	61,718	2025	74	0001403161-25-000089	https://s29.q4cdn....

Questions for the next review

Follow-up register for FY2025. These are investigation questions, not risk scores or probabilities.

Company

Visa

Fiscal year

2025

Questions and limits

Company	Topic	Follow-up question	What this does not show
Visa	Cash timing	How do incentives, tax timing and operating-balance changes explain cash support, without deducting supplemental cash twice?	A ratio above 1 is not proof of recurring cash or debt-service capacity.
Visa	Debt refinancing	How do principal maturities, interest/currency terms and subsequent repayments/new borrowings change the frozen carrying balances?	Higher debt alone is not a default conclusion; carrying amounts are not principal maturities or all financing obligations.
Visa	Liquidity scope	What cash is available for general use after restricted/client funds and settlement buffers, and what other obligations require liquidity?	No current ratio, freely distributable cash or maturity coverage conclusion.
Visa	Margin legal costs	Which disclosed legal, regulatory and operating cost items recur, and how do later legal outcomes change expense and liquidity?	Provision is not same-year cash paid or total potential legal exposure; no normalized profit or legal-outcome probability.
Visa	Operational cyber	Do subsequent material incident, outage or third-party disclosures affect service capacity, costs or financial reporting?	Control/program descriptions do not establish incident absence or quantified residual risk.
Visa	Settlement counterparty	What exposure basis, customer concentration, collateral availability and stressed settlement needs are disclosed on comparable dates?	Disclosed exposure is not expected loss; Visa daily maxima and Mastercard estimated end-date exposure are not a common denominator.
Visa	Source freshness	What later quarterly/annual filings or material events must be reviewed before using these historical signals for a current decision?	The historical baseline does not establish 2026 conditions or whether a stated past maturity was repaid.

Metric definitions

Definitions and limits used in this analysis. All 28 definitions and their original fields remain in the full result tables.

Definitions and limitations

Metric	Formula	Scope and limitations
Balance-sheet cash and cash equivalents	cash_and_cash_equivalents	No substitution of cash-flow ending cash including restricted components; not all cash is necessarily freely distributable.
Cash equivalents / selected debt	cash_and_cash_equivalents / debt_carrying_total	Denominator must be positive. Not current ratio, maturity coverage or proof of repayment ability.
Consolidated net margin	net_income / net_revenue	Denominator must be positive. Negative net income retained; affected by tax/nonoperating items.
Defined capital cash payments	Visa: property/equipment/technology payments; Mastercard: PPE + capitalized software payments	Issuer scope differs. Excludes business acquisitions, investments and leases outside these rows; not uniform company-reported CapEx.
FCF proxy / net revenue	fcf_proxy / net_revenue	Denominator must be positive. Inherits issuer-specific FCF limits; negative values retained.
Issuer-specific customer incentives	Visa reported client incentives; Mastercard derived payment-network revenue deductions using a consistent reclassified scope.	Issuer fiscal dates and scopes differ. Nominal volume is not FX-neutral. Transaction counts are network-specific. Incentives are accrued revenue deductions, not cash paid. Mastercard deductions are derived from rounded network components; FY2023 has a disclosed 1m rounding residual versus narrative.
Issuer-specific payment volume	Worldwide purchases excluding cash, in nominal USD, for each issuer fiscal year.	Issuer fiscal years end on different dates. Worldwide purchase volume excludes cash and is reported in nominal USD; FX movements affect growth. Issuer coverage differs, so this is not a calendar-aligned or FX-neutral market-share comparison. Source evidence: references/industry_evidence.json.
OCF / consolidated net income	operating_cash_flow / net_income	Denominator must be positive. Nonpositive net income undefined; negative OCF retained. Above 1 does not prove sustainable earnings or causes.
OCF less defined capital payments proxy	operating_cash_flow - capital_payments_defined	Non-GAAP analytical proxy; not company-reported FCF, freely distributable cash, recurring cash or debt-service capacity. No litigation/tax adjustments; show OCF-to-proxy bridge.
Operating expense ratio	operating_expenses / net_revenue	Denominator must be positive. Do not double-count customer incentives already netted from revenue.
Operating margin	operating_income / net_revenue	Denominator must be positive. Negative operating income retained; reported GAAP basis.
Operating margin YoY change	100 * (operating_margin[t] - operating_margin[t-1])	Percentage-point difference, not relative percentage growth; requires two valid annual margins.
Processed / switched transactions	Visa processed transactions and Mastercard switched transactions; issuer-specific scopes.	Visa counts processed transactions and Mastercard counts switched transactions. Network coverage and fiscal dates differ; these counts do not represent all branded transactions or active cards. Comparisons are descriptive, with no market-share or per-card conclusion. Source evidence: references/industry_evidence.json.
Reported consolidated net income	net_income	Not automatically parent-attributable earnings or an EPS numerator.
Reported current debt carrying amount	current_debt	Not total current liabilities or next-twelve-month principal; no leases silently added.
Reported net revenue	net_revenue	Issuer-specific revenue mix/incentives; no constant-currency adjustment.
Reported net revenue YoY growth	net_revenue[t] / net_revenue[t-1] - 1	Prior base must be positive. FY2021 is undefined without verified FY2020. Negative current values can yield below -100%; no FX/acquisition normalization.
Reported noncurrent debt carrying amount	noncurrent_debt	Selected disclosed carrying line, not all liabilities or unverified financing.
Reported operating cash flow	operating_cash_flow	Working capital, tax and litigation timing may affect cash; not recurring cash by default.
Reported operating expenses	operating_expenses	GAAP costs retained; no special-item or litigation adjustment.
Reported operating income	operating_income	Not adjusted operating income.
Reported operating income YoY growth	operating_income[t] / operating_income[t-1] - 1	Prior base must be positive. FY2021 is undefined without verified FY2020. Negative current values can yield below -100%; no FX/acquisition normalization.
Reported total assets	total_assets	Includes noncash assets and goodwill; not liquidity.
Reported total liabilities	total_liabilities	Includes operating, settlement and tax liabilities; not pure borrowing.
Selected current + noncurrent debt carrying total	current_debt + noncurrent_debt	Both components must be present, including explicit reported zero. Not total liabilities, principal maturities, leases or all unverified obligations.
Selected debt / total assets	debt_carrying_total / total_assets	Denominator must be positive. Not liabilities/assets; asset mix and goodwill affect interpretation.
Selected debt less cash-equivalents proxy	debt_carrying_total - cash_and_cash_equivalents	Retain negatives, never floor at zero. No restricted cash, investments, leases or other financing added; no claim all cash is freely available.
Total liabilities / total assets	total_liabilities / total_assets	Denominator must be positive. Includes operating/settlement/tax liabilities; not pure borrowing leverage.

Network activity and revenue deductions

Reported FY2021-2025. Purchases exclude cash; transaction and deduction scopes differ between issuers.

Issuer-specific operating measures

Company	Fiscal year	Purchases (USD bn)	Network transactions (m)	Revenue deductions (USDm)
Mastercard	2021	5,959	112,090	10,476
Mastercard	2022	6,571	125,680	12,445
Mastercard	2023	7,345	143,196	15,181
Mastercard	2024	8,003	159,424	17,629
Mastercard	2025	8,799	175,464	20,522
Visa	2021	10,401	164,734	8,367
Visa	2022	11,614	192,530	10,295
Visa	2023	12,338	212,579	12,297
Visa	2024	13,193	233,758	13,764
Visa	2025	14,217	257,545	15,751

Visa reports processed transactions; Mastercard reports switched transactions. Revenue deductions are not cash paid.
Mastercard FY2023: derived USD15,181m vs narrative USD15,182m from rounded inputs. Full scope and source notes are in README.